

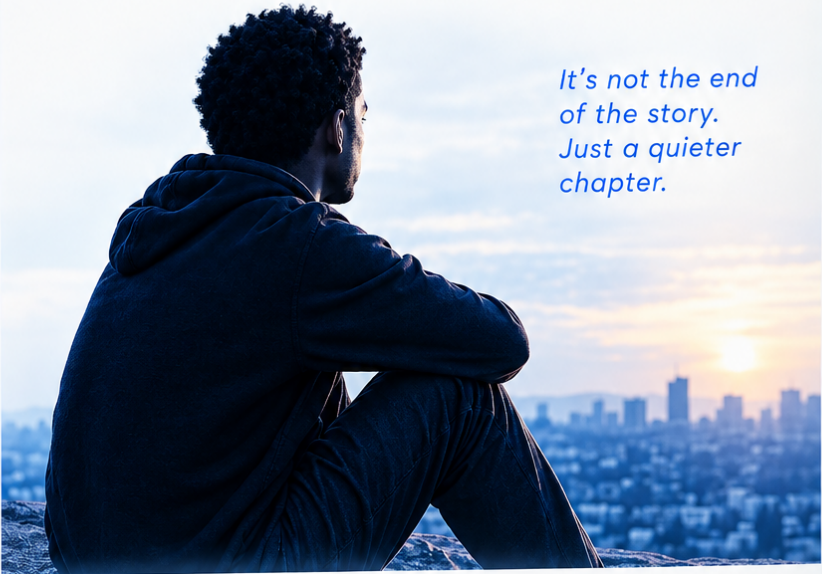


MindShift
BOOKS

WHEN GOD FEELS SILENT

Finding Hope, Clarity and Strength
When You Don't Hear Anything

*It's not the end
of the story.
Just a quieter
chapter.*



A MINDSHIFT BOOKS PUBLICATION

WHEN GOD FEELS SILENT

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PREFACE

Before You Read This

This book is for a specific season, not every season. It's for the stretch when prayer feels like it's hitting a ceiling, when grief hasn't resolved into anything tidy, when doubt has started to feel like betrayal, and when God — who used to feel close — has started to feel quiet.

It will not try to explain your particular silence away. It doesn't know your particular story, and it would be dishonest to pretend otherwise. What it offers instead is company — Scripture's own record of people who waited, grieved, doubted, and stayed anyway — and a handful of small, honest practices for staying close to God in a season that doesn't come with a finish line.

Each chapter follows the same shape: a real ache named plainly, a table clearing away common misunderstandings, a story from Scripture worth sitting with, a short reflection, and a small close — one verse, one prayer — for today specifically, not for the whole season at once.

You don't have to read this in order, and you don't have to read it quickly. Take the chapter that matches where you actually are.

CHAPTER 1

When Heaven Feels Quiet

Naming The Ache Before Trying To Fix It

IN THIS CHAPTER

- Why silence feels like the cruelest kind of “no”
- The difference between God's absence and God's silence
- What this book will — and won't — try to do

There is a specific pain that doesn't come from what God has said, but from what He hasn't. You prayed. You waited. And then — nothing. No verse that leapt off the page. No word from a friend that felt like it was meant for you. Just the quiet.

This is not a book that will make the silence make sense. It isn't a formula, and this particular ache doesn't resolve in five steps. What follows is something smaller, and we hope more honest: a companion for the seasons when God feels far — grief that doesn't explain itself, prayers that don't seem to land, doubt that feels like betrayal.

If you came looking for a chapter that explains the silence away, we don't have that chapter. What we have is permission — to name the silence honestly, to sit inside it without pretending it doesn't hurt, and to notice, slowly, that silence and absence are not always the same thing.

WHAT SILENCE OFTEN FEELS LIKE	WHAT IS OFTEN ALSO TRUE
“God has forgotten me”	“Can a woman forget her sucking child... yet will I not forget thee” — Isaiah 49:15
“My faith must be too weak for this”	The Psalms are full of loud complaint from people Scripture calls faithful.
“This silence means something is wrong with me”	Job's friends said that. Job was the one God ultimately vindicated.

A STORY WORTH SITTING WITH

Job's Long Silence. Before anyone said a word of bad theology to Job, his three friends sat with him on the ground for seven days and seven nights, and none of them spoke, because they saw that his grief was very great. The most faithful thing anyone did in that story happened before the talking started.

“Silence from God is not the same thing as the absence of God.”

SIT WITH THIS

- Where does the silence feel loudest in your life right now?
- What have you secretly feared the silence means about you?

FOR TODAY

Verse: “How long wilt thou forget me, O LORD? for ever?” — Psalm 13:1

Prayer: Lord, I don't understand the quiet. Meet me in it anyway.

CHAPTER 2

The Grief That Doesn't Explain Itself

When Loss Arrives Without A Reason Attached

IN THIS CHAPTER

- Why grief and God's silence so often arrive together
- The difference between explaining grief and being present to it
- Why “everything happens for a reason” can wound more than it heals

Grief rarely waits for an explanation before it arrives, and it rarely leaves once it gets one. You can know every verse about heaven and still ache for the empty chair. You can trust God's goodness in general and still not understand this particular loss in specific.

Well-meaning people often reach for a reason — “God needed another angel,” “it was their time” — because an unexplained loss is harder to sit next to than an explained one. But Scripture rarely rushes to explain grief. It much more often simply records it: Abraham wept for Sarah. David wept for his son. Jesus, who knew exactly how the story of Lazarus would end in a few minutes, wept

anyway.

If your grief hasn't resolved into a tidy lesson, you are not doing it wrong. Some griefs are simply griefs — and the silence that follows a loss is not evidence that God has left. Sometimes it is evidence that He is sitting close enough not to need to say anything yet.

A COMMON RESPONSE TO GRIEF	A MORE HONEST ONE
“Everything happens for a reason”	Some losses don't have a reason we get to see — and that's allowed to just be true.
“Don't be sad, they're in a better place”	Jesus wept at a grave He was about to empty — grief and hope were not opposites to Him.
“You should be over this by now”	Scripture's mourning periods were long and communal, not brief and private.

A STORY WORTH SITTING WITH

Jesus At The Tomb. *John records that Jesus, standing outside Lazarus's tomb, knowing He was about to raise him, wept anyway. Full knowledge of the ending did not cancel the grief of the moment. Your grief does not need to make theological sense to be allowed in God's presence — it was allowed in His.*

This Has Been a Free Preview

You've just read the opening of *When God Feels Silent* — the Preface, Chapter 1, and the start of Chapter 2. The rest of Hannah's, Habakkuk's, Thomas's, David's, and Job's stories are waiting in the full book.

Still Ahead in the Full Book

Chapter 2 (continued) — The Grief That Doesn't Explain Itself

Chapter 3 — The Prayer That Never Got An Answer

Chapter 4 — When Doubt Feels Like Betrayal

Chapter 5 — The Company Of The Waiting

Chapter 6 — Comparing Your Silence To Someone Else's Noise

Chapter 7 — What Silence Is Not

Chapter 8 — Learning To Stay

Final Words — You Are Not Alone In The Quiet

Appendix — Verses For Hard Days — a one-page reference for hard days

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Get the full book to keep reading.

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